

The Importance of Testing Web Applications

The demands of modern commercial enterprises make it mandatory for each organisation to have a website or Web application. The quality of the website or application plays an important role in how customers perceive the company and, in turn, how much faith they have in its products. In this scenario, rigorous testing of the website and the application becomes critical.



In today's competitive world, the Internet has become an integral part of our lives. Most of us make our decisions by searching for information on the Internet; hence, having a Web application has become mandatory for all kinds of businesses.

To begin with, let us try to understand what we mean when we talk of a Web application.

A Web application (Web app) is a computer program that is stored on a remote server and delivered over the Internet through a browser interface.

A website indirectly builds an image of the organisation for its customers. The more informative, simple, accessible, user friendly, secure and faster the Web application is, the better is the perception and image about the company that is built in its customers' minds. To have all these qualities, the Web app should be well tested.

Let us look at the different phases of Web application testing.

Functional testing

In functional testing, we check if the product (Web app) is as per the functional specifications mentioned in the product

documentation received from a business analyst or product owner. Testing activities include checking all the positive and negative scenarios written by a QA (quality assurance) member for the application.

Examples include validating textbox inputs, checking for broken links, checking cookie related operations, etc.

Initially, these tests are performed by a manual tester, and at a later point, automated scripts can be run for regression testing.

Tools that can be used: QTP, Selenium, UFT

Usability testing

This is a process of testing a Web application to determine how user friendly the Web app is. Normally, these tests are carried out by users who resemble the target audience. Here are some checks included in usability testing.

1. Checking the simplicity and ease of use of the Web app compared to its competitors. An example of such testing is the mechanism used to determine whether the user is a bot, such as Captcha.
2. The attractiveness of the website in comparison to its competitors.